

HiveForce Labs

THREAT ADVISORY



ATTACK REPORT

Internet Explorer Zero-Day Vulnerability Exploited by APT 37

Date of Publication

December 9, 2022

Admiralty Code

A1

TA Number

TA2022291

Summary

First appeared: October 31, 2022

Threat Actors: APT37

Attack Region: China, Czech, Hong Kong, India, Japan, Kuwait, Nepal, Poland, Romania, Russia, South Korea, UK, USA, Vietnam.

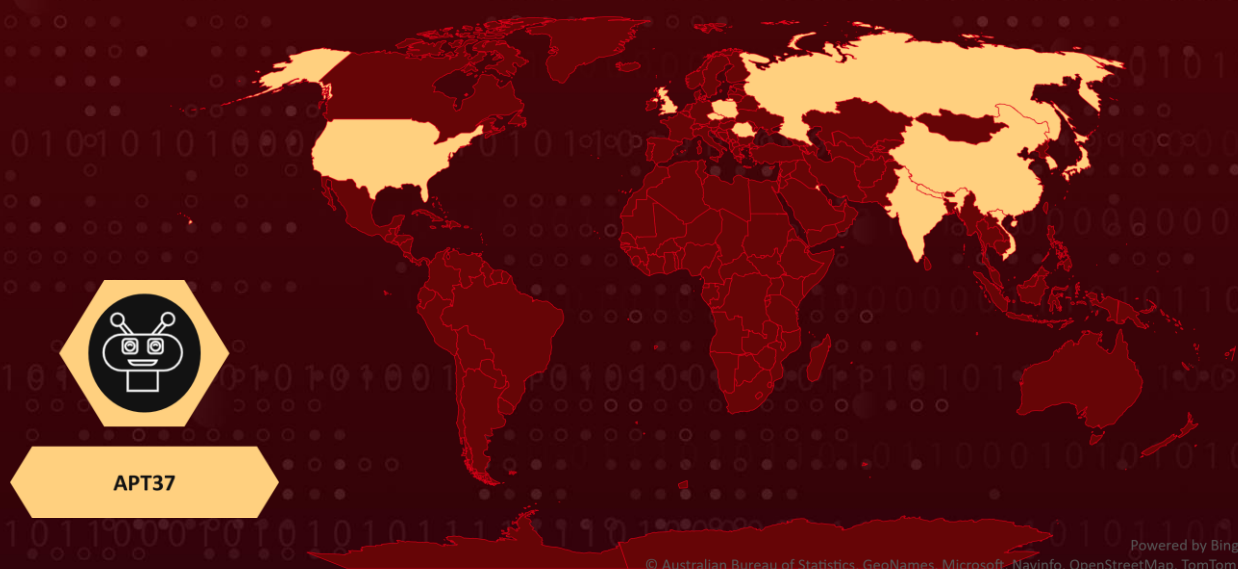
Attack Industries: Aerospace, Automotive, Chemical, Financial, Government, Healthcare, High-Tech, Manufacturing, Technology, Transportation.

Attack: CVE-2022-41128 was leveraged by APT37 to implant backdoors in the targeted device.

🔧 CVE

CVE	NAME	PATCH
CVE-2022-41128	Windows Scripting Languages Remote Code Execution Vulnerability	✓

🗡️ Attack Regions



Attack Details

#1

North Korean hackers identified as APT37 exploited a previously unknown Internet Explorer zero-day vulnerability to infect South Koreans, North Korean defectors, policymakers, journalists, and human rights activists. The vulnerability is discovered in the browser's "JScript9" JavaScript engine, and when exploited by remote attackers, it allows them to inject malicious code into a target system.

#2

To trigger the exploit, an attacker would need to delude the alleged target into visiting a specially crafted server share or website. Once opened on the victims' devices, the document would deliver an unknown payload after downloading a rich text file (RTF) remote template that would render remote HTML using Internet Explorer. The threat actors are known for employing a wide spectrum of malware, including backdoors such as Bluelight, Dolphin, and Rokrat, in their attacks.

Recommendations



Security Leaders

Phishing simulations and routine education and awareness training and communications rarely account for MFA fatigue and web browser hygiene. Integrate and communicate all lessons learned.



Security Engineers

- **Uni5 Users:** This is an actionable threat advisory in HivePro Uni5. Prioritize and block all indicators attributed to the threat actors and attacks through your Command Center. Test your controls with Uni5's Breach & Attack Simulation.
- **All Engineers:** Refer to and action upon the 'Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs' & 'Indicators of Compromise (IoC)' on the following pages.

Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs

<u>TA0042</u> Resource Development	<u>TA0001</u> Initial Access	<u>TA0002</u> Execution	<u>TA0003</u> Persistence
<u>TA0005</u> Defense Evasion	<u>TA0007</u> Discovery	<u>TA0008</u> Lateral Movement	<u>TA0009</u> Collection
<u>TA0011</u> Command and Control	<u>TA0040</u> Impact	<u>T1587</u> Develop Capabilities	<u>T1588</u> Obtain Capabilities
<u>T1588.006</u> Vulnerabilities	<u>T1059</u> Command and Scripting Interpreter	<u>T1059.003</u> Windows Command Shell	<u>T1547</u> Boot or Logon Autostart Execution
<u>T1547.001</u> Registry Run Keys / Startup Folder	<u>T1189</u> Drive-by Compromise	<u>T1055</u> Process Injection	<u>T1057</u> Process Discovery
<u>T1082</u> System Information Discovery	<u>T1106</u> Native API	<u>T1105</u> Ingress Tool Transfer	<u>T1204</u> User Execution
<u>T1204.002</u> Malicious File			

Indicator of Compromise (IOCs)

TYPE	VALUE
SHA256	56ca24b57c4559f834c190d50b0fe89dd4a4040a078ca1f267d0bbc7849e9ed7 af5fb99d3ff18bc625fb63f792ed7cd955171ab509c2f8e7c7ee44515e09cebf 926a947ea2b59d3e9a5a6875b4de2bd071b15260370f4da5e2a60ece3517a32f 3bff571823421c013e79cc10793f238f4252f7d7ac91f9ef41435af0a8c09a39 c49b4d370ad0dcd1e28ee8f525ac8e3c12a34cfcf62ebb733ec74cca59b29f82 08f93351d0d3905bee5b0c2b9215d448abb0d3cf49c0f8b666c46df4fcc007cb

TYPE	VALUE
Domains	word-template[.]net openxmlformat[.]org ms-office[.]services ms-offices[.]com template-openxml[.]com

Patch Link

<https://msrc.microsoft.com/update-guide/en-US/vulnerability/CVE-2022-41128>

References

<https://blog.google/threat-analysis-group/internet-explorer-0-day-exploited-by-north-korean-actor-apt37/>

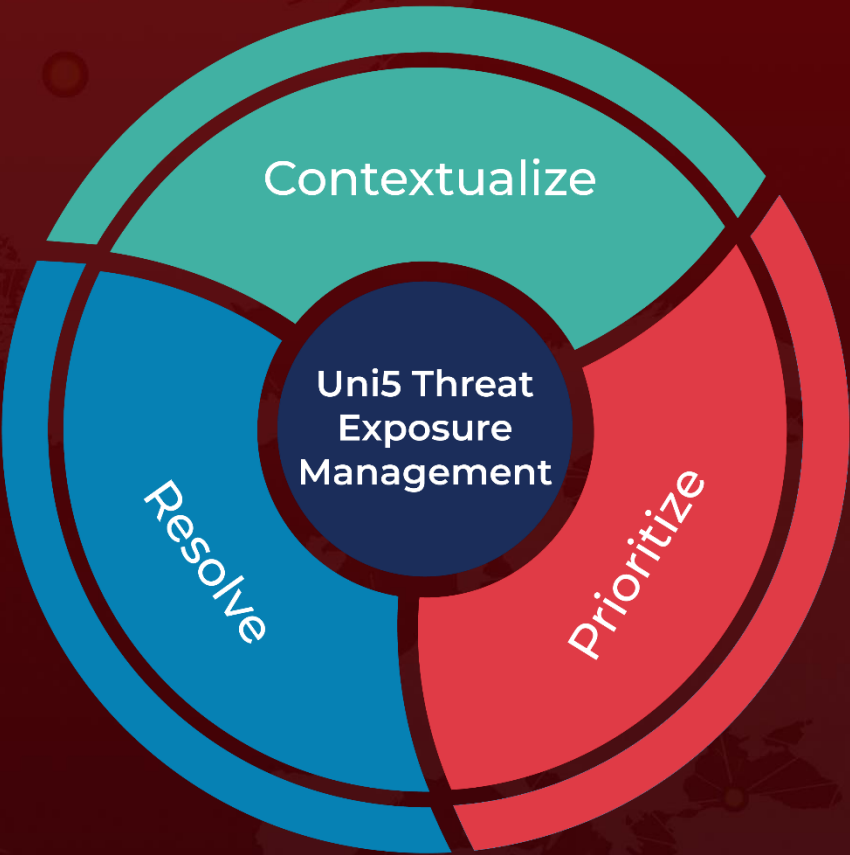
<https://www.hivepro.com/how-scarcruft-apt-group-enhances-its-toolkit-with-a-powerful-dolphin-backdoor/>

<https://attack.mitre.org/groups/G0067/>

What Next?

At Hive Pro, it is our mission to detect the most likely threats to your organization and to help you prevent them from happening.

Book a free demo with HivePro Uni5: Threat Exposure Management Platform.



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December 9, 2022 • 3:33 AM

